Outreach scripts that get replies

Copy, paste, make them yours. Every script opens with something true about THEM, is short, and asks for one small thing. They're written for websites, the easiest door-opener. Selling SEO, reviews, social, ads or automations? Swap in your opener from "Openers for what you sell".

The order that works for local businesses

Freelancers consistently report the same ranking for local owners: **walk in > call > DM > email.** Email is the easiest to send and the easiest to ignore, so use it after a call or walk-in, or when a business only publishes an email.

Three rules for every channel:

1. **The first line is about them:** their reviews, their broken page, their opening, a question a customer asked. In Hunter's data (31M emails, 2025), two details about the recipient lifted replies from 3.6% to 5.6%.
2. **Short, with two follow-ups.** Belkins' study of 16.5 million cold emails found messages under 200 words beat longer ones, and Hunter's look at 31 million cold emails sent in 2025 found the best sequences were three emails in total (6.8% reply rate vs 3.3% for a single email); following up three or more times lowered replies.
3. **One message per business, written for that business.** No blasts. Send from your own domain (you@yourbusiness.com), not a free Gmail address: Hunter saw 5.2% replies from custom domains vs 2.5% from free ones.

Walk-in (20 seconds, storefronts, salons, restaurants)

Go at a quiet time (mid-morning or mid-afternoon). Ask for the owner by name if you know it.

> "Hi, is [owner] around? I'm [name], I build websites for local [trade]. I saw you have [87] great reviews on Google but no website, so I made you a quick preview. Can I show you? Takes 30 seconds."

Show the preview on your phone. Leave your one-pager. If it's a bad time: "No problem, when's better?"

Phone call (30 seconds)

> "Hi, is this [owner]? I'm [name], I'm local, I build websites for [trade]. Quick reason for the call: you've got [4.9 stars from 112 reviews], but when people Google you they land on [Yelp / nothing / a page that won't load]. I built a preview of what your site could look like. Can I text or email you the link?"

Got the email? Send the preview within 10 minutes.

Voicemail (20 seconds)

> "Hi [owner], [name] here, local web designer. You've got great reviews, and I built a free preview of a website for [business]. I'll email it over. If you want it, call me back at [number]. Again, [number]."

DM (businesses that only have Facebook or Instagram)

> "Hi [name], love your work on [the post/job]. I noticed your page is your main 'website', so I built you a proper one from your Google listing, free to look at: [link]. Want me to put it live on your own domain?"

Cold email (about 50–80 words, only to an email the business publishes)

Subject: a website for [Business Name]

> Hi [Name],
>
> [Specific, true line: "Your 112 reviews say you're the best deck builder in Broken Arrow, but Googling you lands on Yelp."] I built a preview of what your site could look like: [link]
>
> Want me to put it live on your own domain this week?
>
> [Your name] · [business] · [phone] · [business mailing address] Reply "no thanks" and I won't email again.

The follow-ups (two, shorter each time, then stop)

- **Day 3–4, a different channel if you can:** "Hi [Name], just checking you saw the preview I made for [Business]: [link]. Happy to change anything."

- **Day 10–14:** "Last note from me: the preview's still here if you ever want it: [link]. All the best with the season."

Then stop. No reply after the third touch means not now.

Warm intro (when a friend gives you a name)

Ask your friend to text first: "Hey [owner], my friend [your name] builds websites for local businesses, worth a chat." Then you: "Hi [owner], [friend] said I should reach out. I had a look at [business] online and made you a quick preview..."

Openers for what you sell

You sell	A true first line (check it before you say it)	The small thing you offer
Websites	"You've got 4.9★ from 112 reviews, but Googling you lands on Yelp."	a preview of their own site
Local SEO	"When I search 'deck builder Broken Arrow', three competitors show on the map and you don't, with fewer reviews."	a one-page "what customers see" sheet
Reviews	"Your last Google review is from March; the shop down the street got 9 this month."	a review-request text they can use today
Social	"Your last Instagram post is from the spring, and that patio job deserved to be seen."	3 post ideas from their own photos
Ads	"When I search '[trade] [town]', four competitors' ads show before you do."	a list of who's advertising for their trade
Automations	"Two of your recent reviews mention nobody calling back."	a demo of a missed-call text-back with their name on it

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When they answer

- **"How much?"** "Most owners go with [middle package] at [price]. Before we talk numbers, can I show you what you'd get?"
- **"Who is this? How did you get my number?"** "Fair question: it's on your Google listing. I'm [name], local. I'm not asking for money today, I just built you a preview."
- **"I have a guy."** "Great, keep the preview as ideas for him. If it ever doesn't work out, I'm here."
- **"Not interested."** "No problem at all, thanks for your time." And stop. Don't contact them again.

The rules (plain words, not legal advice; checked November 2026)

- **US email (CAN-SPAM):** an honest subject line and "from" (no fake "Re:"), make it clear it's a business offer, include your business name, mailing address and an easy opt-out that keeps working for 30 days, and honor opt-outs within 10 business days. Fines go up to $53,088 per email.
- **US calls and texts (TCPA + state laws):** call by hand. Never cold text: texts count as calls, and Florida, Maryland, Texas, Virginia and Washington let people sue per message. No auto-dialers, prerecorded or AI voices and no "ringless" voicemails to cell phones (many owners list a cell). Check the Do Not Call list before calling a cell.
- **Canada (CASL):** email only an address the business itself published (with no "no solicitations" note next to it), about something relevant to that person's job. Every message needs your name, mailing address, a way to reach you and an unsubscribe. Screenshot where you found the address: it's on you to prove it. CASL covers texts and DMs too. Got a referral? One message is OK if you name who referred you.
- **UK/EU:** company addresses are OK with an opt-out in the UK; sole traders and many EU countries need consent first.
- Everywhere: the moment anyone says stop, stop.

Free skills that find the leads and write the first message for each: github.com/WordRocket/local-client-finder. Sources: Hunter, State of Email Outreach 2026 (31M emails); Belkins cold email studies 2025–2026; FTC CAN-SPAM compliance guide; FCC TCPA rules; CRTC CASL guidance. Results vary.